DIGITAL LITERACY

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INTRODUCTION

Digital literacy is an essential skill in today's technology-driven world, especially for students navigating academic and professional environments. This project was undertaken as part of the Digital Literacy course to develop a comprehensive understanding of online tools, communication practices, and cyber safety. Acting as a Student Digital Ambassador, the objective was to create a portfolio that demonstrates awareness of digital platforms, responsible online behavior, and effective communication. The project consists of five tasks covering infographic design, professional portfolio creation, coding platforms, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. Each task contributed to building practical knowledge and real-world skills that are highly relevant in modern education and career development. This report documents the process, tools used, and key learnings from each task.

TASK 1- INFOGRAPHICS

For this task, I used Canva to design a digital literacy awareness infographic. The infographic covers three main topics: what digital literacy is, safe internet practices, and maintaining a professional online presence. It explains digital literacy as the ability to effectively and responsibly use digital tools and platforms. The section on safe internet practices includes points such as avoiding suspicious links, protecting personal information, and using strong passwords. The professional online presence section highlights the importance of maintaining a clean digital footprint, especially on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub.

One challenge I faced was balancing visual appeal with content clarity. Adding too much text made the infographic cluttered, while too little reduced its informative value. This task helped me understand how to communicate information concisely and visually, which is an important skill in both academic and professional contexts.

TASK 2- PORTFOLIO

In this task, I created and updated my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate to establish a professional digital presence. GitHub is used for showcasing projects and coding work, LinkedIn serves as a professional networking platform, and ResearchGate is useful for data science and machine learning research. On GitHub, I created a profile README that includes my academic background and learning goals. On LinkedIn, I completed the Education section with details about my degree, institution, and expected graduation year.

These platforms play a significant role in building a professional identity. This task made me realize that building an online presence early can create opportunities for

internships and collaborations. It also highlighted the importance of consistency and authenticity in maintaining professional profiles.

TASK 3- PLATFORMS AND TOOLS

For this task, I explored both coding practice platforms and collaborative tools. I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level problem, which

helped me understand the basics of problem-solving and coding environments. Platforms like HackerRank are valuable for improving logical thinking and preparing for technical interviews.

In addition, I created a Google Form titled “Digital Literacy Quiz” consisting of five questions, including both multiple-choice and short-answer types. This form can be used to assess awareness among students about digital literacy concepts. I also linked the form to a Google Sheet to collect responses and analyze data efficiently.

These tools are highly beneficial in an academic setting. Coding platforms help in skill development, while tools like Google Forms simplify data collection and collaboration. This task emphasized the importance of using digital tools not just for learning but also for organizing and sharing information effectively.

TASK 4- EMAIL ETIQUETTE

Effective communication is a critical aspect of digital literacy. In this task, I drafted two professional emails: one requesting an assignment extension and another expressing interest in an internship opportunity.

A common issue in digital communication is the misuse of tone, which can lead to misunderstandings or negative impressions. This can result in missed opportunities or delayed responses. To avoid such situations, it is important to maintain clarity, politeness, and structure in all professional communication.

TASK 5- CYBERCRIME

While researching cybercrime, I focused on UPI and online payment fraud, which is highly relevant in India. I was surprised by how simple techniques, such as fake payment links or phishing messages, can lead to significant financial loss. Many victims are targeted due to a lack of awareness or urgency created by scammers.

One important habit I will adopt is verifying all payment requests and avoiding clicking on unknown links. I will also ensure that I never share sensitive information such as OTPs or UPI PINs. This task highlighted the importance of awareness and caution while using digital payment systems. Understanding these risks is essential for protecting oneself and educating others about safe online practices.

CONCLUSION

This project provided a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and its practical applications. Through various tasks, I learned how to create informative content, build a professional online presence, use collaborative tools, communicate effectively, and stay safe online. The experience emphasized that digital literacy is not just about using technology but also about using it responsibly and strategically. The skills developed during this project will be useful in both academic and professional environments. Overall, this project has increased my awareness and confidence in navigating the digital world effectively.

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